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Chapter 1

Report Creation



Report Creation Overview

This section is designed to give you a structured overview of the several stages needed in the creation and maintenance of a report. Subsequent sections will explain in greater detail how you can make your way through these stages and produce a finished report.

Stages in Report Creation

Stage 1

Examine the data dictionary. It already contains system-defined fields which should prove useful to you in the definition of your reports. If you need extra fields you can define them.

Stage 2

A report is comprised of three types of format. The first contains information relevant to its headings and is called the Header format. The second has the body of the report and is called the Detail format. The third will contain the totals at the base of the report; this is the Total format.

Having drawn up a report design, decide how it should be split into these three format types.

Stage 3

Define the three formats that will go to make up the report. You will give them names and descriptions and define some controlling parameters for each format.

Stage 4

Enter the text you want to see on the finished report in the relevant formats - probably the header and total formats. Fields in the report format which contain text are called literal fields.

Allocate or create and allocate fields which will call up data from the General Ledger and display it on the report. Such fields are called variable fields and are usually contained in the detail and total formats.

You can also create hidden fields to help you in the calculation of values destined for the report. These are work fields.

Having defined fields for the format you might also want to make use of modifiers so that you can print batches of similar reports.

Stage 5

You have created three separate formats for a report. You should now pull them together into a single report. Define a report by giving it a name and description and allocating to it the required format types.

When defining the report you should also specify from where the variable fields in its formats are going to access their data. To do this, specify single accounts, groups of accounts, views (combinations of account levels which can span single or multiple ledgers) or hierarchies, which exist on the General Ledger.

Stage 6

The report has been defined. You now need to compile it so that it is in a form understandable to the report generation program.

Stage 7

Finally run the finished report. A batch job is submitted to the system and a print generated.

An outline of the inputs and processes of the system is shown in the following diagram:

